

LET'S BEGIN WITH HOMEGUARD™

Overall Objective

Building simple habits that help homeowners take real ownership — with smart, professional guidance every step of the way.




**HOMEGUARD™
PRO**



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WRITING CREDIT

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HomeGuard™ Preventative Home Maintenance System

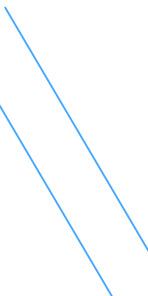
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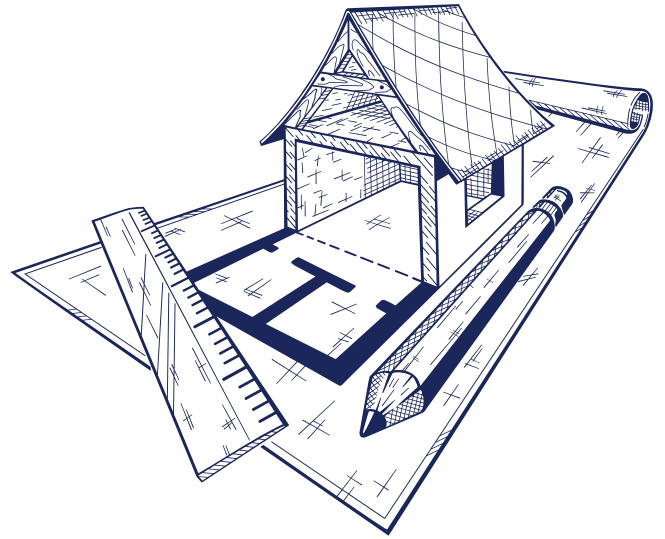


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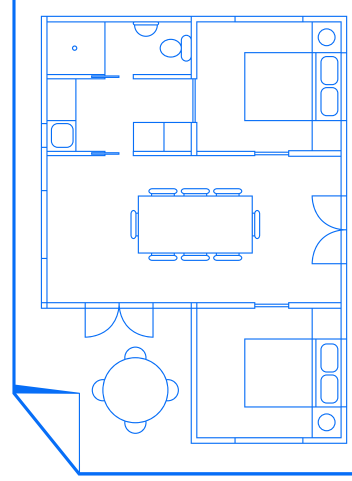
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HOMEGUARD™



Welcome to the Guide:

Your commitment to prevention begins here.

Congratulations on taking a smart step toward protecting your biggest investment—your home. **HomeGuard™** isn't just a guide; it's a system built to give you peace of mind, one habit at a time. Whether you're fixing a small crack or planning for a bigger project, this guide will help you stay in control, save money, and feel confident in your decisions.



Key Reminders

- Simple monthly tasks that prevent costly surprises
- Pro tips from experienced contractors
- Easy-to-use templates to track everything in one place
- Tools and resources that grow with you
- Upgrade-ready system if you want to go further later



*You've already done more than most by choosing to be proactive.
Let's get started—your home (and your future self) will thank you for it.*



HOW THIS GUIDE WORKS

*Simple steps. Smart habits.
Powerful results.*

HomeGuard™ is more than just a checklist—it's a rhythm. We've designed it to help you form small monthly habits that build toward big results. By consistently observing, recording, and taking action when needed, you'll prevent costly repairs, extend your home's lifespan, and feel more confident as a homeowner.



This guide is structured to be simple, repeatable, and empowering—especially for those who rushed to buy their homes in the past few years and are still learning what it takes to maintain it.

HomeGuard™ turns maintenance into a habit you'll actually stick with. Instead of reacting to problems, you'll learn how to stay ahead of them with easy monthly actions. It's a smart, flexible system designed to help you feel in control—no tools or experience required.



HOW THIS GUIDE WORKS: CONTINUED



What You Can Expect Each Month:

- Observe the outside of your home with a fresh set of eyes
- Complete simple checks or fixes—even if you’ve never done them before
- Log your findings using easy templates (included inside)
- Take early action if you spot something unusual
- Learn from ProTips that explain the why behind each step



What’s Inside the Guide:

- Step-by-step structure for monthly checks
- Pro-level insights in friendly, everyday language
- Ready-to-print or fillable digital templates
- Example questions for contractors (when help is needed)
- Options to upgrade for extra features, reminders, and digital access



The Goal

*To make you the kind of homeowner who prevents damage,
avoids stress, and saves thousands—without feeling
overwhelmed.*



YOUR MONTHLY HOME RHYTHM

Just **5 smart moves**. One powerful habit.

Step 1: Walk + Observe



Step 2: Test + Check



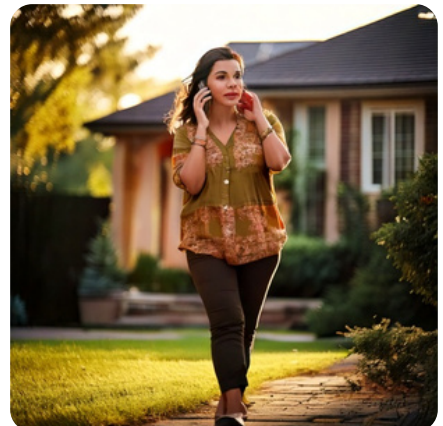
Step 3: Fix the Easy Stuff



Step 4: Record It



Step 5: Flag for a Pro

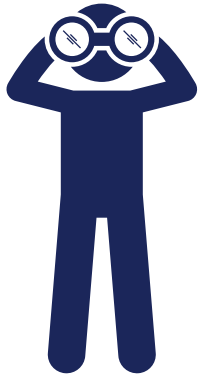


LET'S BEGIN!

Just **5 smart moves**. One powerful habit.

Step 1: Walk + Observe

"See what others ignore."



Every home tells a story—you just have to slow down enough to notice it. That's why this first step is all about **observation**. Once a month, take a calm, intentional walk around the outside of your home. No tools, no stress—just you noticing what's changed.

Pay attention to things like discoloration on siding, shifting soil, damp spots, sagging trim, or cracks along the foundation. These small signs often appear long before something breaks. Think of it like learning your home's language—eventually, you'll spot what doesn't belong without even trying.

And once something catches your eye, it's time to move in closer and check whether it's worth fixing—or just worth noting.



⚙️ Step 2: Test + Check

"Feel your way to peace of mind."

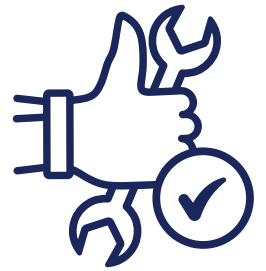
Now that you've looked around, it's time to interact with your home. This step is about safely testing the things you rely on every day—windows, doors, vents, siding panels, and gutter edges. You're not diagnosing problems; you're just feeling for anything that seems off.

Sometimes, **the early warning signs aren't visual—they're physical**. A *window that sticks, a loose trim corner, or a spongy section of siding* can tell you more than a crack ever could. These are the little signals your home gives when something's wearing out or shifting beneath the surface.

And if something feels off but easy to handle? The next pillar will show you how to take quick, confident action without needing to call for backup.



Just **5 smart moves.** *One powerful habit.*



Step 3: Fix the Easy Stuff

"A 10-minute win can save a \$1,000 repair."

This pillar is about **momentum**. Once you've spotted something minor—and you're sure it's safe to handle—go ahead and take care of it right then. Clearing leaves from a clogged downspout, making sure the lower end of the downspout has a clear path for proper drainage, tightening a loose hinge, or sealing a small gap doesn't require a contractor. It just takes a few minutes and a little awareness.



You're not trying to overhaul your home—you're stacking small wins. These quick actions stop moisture from spreading, bugs from entering, and wear from escalating. They're the kind of fixes that, when ignored, lead to headaches down the road.

But what if the issue is too big or too unfamiliar?
That's exactly where smart homeowners hit pause—
and pull out the notebook.

Just 5 smart moves. *One powerful habit.*



Step 4: Record It

"Write it down now. Understand it later."

Once you've acted—or chosen not to—it's time to document what you saw, did, or decided to monitor. Use the included templates to jot a quick note: what area you checked, what condition it's in, and whether any action was taken. It doesn't need to be perfect—just consistent.

Over time, these notes become a powerful tool. You'll spot patterns, track wear, and—if needed—prove to your insurance provider that you've been actively maintaining your home.

And if what you've recorded feels beyond your comfort zone, that's your cue to lean on the fifth and final pillar.

Record ...



... No, Not Yourself :)



Just 5 smart moves. *One powerful habit.*



Step 5: Flag for a Pro

"The right pro at the right time can save your entire exterior."

Most homeowners don't notice something's wrong until water shows up or wood starts to shift—and that's especially true if you bought your home quickly, like so many people did during the rush of recent years. You weren't handed a manual, and no one walked you through what to watch for outside. That's not your fault—but now you have a chance to pay attention before the damage demands your attention.

You don't need to know exactly what's wrong. You just need to trust your instincts—when something doesn't look or feel right, that's enough. Flag it, tag it in your notes, and keep moving. That simple act means you've done your part for now—and you'll be ready if and when it needs a professional's attention.



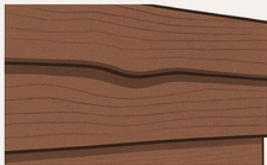
What most homeowners miss — & how to stay ahead.

HIDDEN WEAR SIGNS



Subtle discoloration on siding or trim

Small cracks in caulking/sealant lines

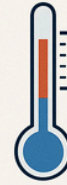


Slight warping or soft spots on wood/vinyl

Gutters starting to separate from fascia



SEASONAL SURPRISE RISKS



Sudden temperature swings causing material contraction



Wind-driven rain exposing weak roof sections



Ice dams forming on shaded roof slopes



Heavy pollen or debris clogging gutters faster than expected



Landscaping Traps

- Tree limbs quietly rubbing against siding or roof edges
- Mulch piled too high against foundation walls
- Shrubs blocking airflow, encouraging moisture buildup



5. Pro Tips- Extension *More examples*

What most homeowners miss — & how to stay ahead.



Missing and slipped shingles — exposed underlayment lets water in.



Lifted shingle edge — a wind and water entry point.



5. Pro Tips- Extension *More examples*

What most homeowners miss — & how to stay ahead.



Rotted fascia and roof-edge decay — flag for a pro before it spreads.



5. Pro Tips- *Extension* *More examples*

What most homeowners miss — & how to stay ahead.



*Dented exhaust vent cap with a lifted flange —
check the seal after storms.*





5. Pro Tips- *Extension* *Continued*



What most homeowners miss — & how to stay ahead.

SMALL HABIT WINS

☒

A small icon of a person walking, representing a perimeter walk.

Walk perimeter after every major storm (even mild)

☒

A small icon of a window, representing window weep holes.

Clean window weep holes twice per year

☒

A small icon of a faucet, representing exterior spigots.

Run water through exterior spigots before winter freeze

✓ **Pro Mindset Shift:**

- “If I flag it now, I control it.”
- Early tags prevent emergency repairs
- Build simple habits = protect your long-term equity



You’ve got this:

Every small check today prevents the \$5,000 repair tomorrow.

These ProTips are designed to help you see what most homeowners overlook.



Looking Ahead:

Taking Action With Confidence

INSPECT LIKE THIS



Simple Inspection Steps

- Notice and document issues
- Take fresh photos regularly
- When in doubt, consult a pro

✓ You've done
the work !!!
— now stay in
control

Spotting a problem doesn't mean panic —

it means you're ahead of the curve.
Let's keep it simple.



HomeGuard™

GLOSSARY



HomeGuard™ Glossary

HVAC Filter:

A filter in heating and cooling systems that removes dust and particles from air before it circulates through your home.

Caulking:

A flexible material used to seal gaps or joints in windows, doors, or siding to prevent moisture intrusion.

Grading:

The slope of land around your home that directs water away from the foundation to avoid water damage.

Moisture Intrusion:

Any unwanted water that seeps into building materials, potentially leading to mold, rot, or structural issues.

Downspout Extension:

An attachment that helps move water further away from your foundation to reduce flooding or erosion.

Saturation Point:

The level at which a material can no longer absorb moisture and begins to allow water damage.

Drip Edge:

Metal installed at roof edges to guide water off shingles and into gutters, preventing damage.

Sealant Failure:

When caulking or sealant cracks, shrinks, or loses adhesion, allowing moisture to enter.

Flashing:

Thin metal or plastic material installed to direct water away from vulnerable areas (like chimneys, skylights, or roof valleys).

Soffit:

The underside of roof overhangs, often ventilated, which helps prevent moisture buildup in the attic.

Fascia:

The flat board running along the roof edge where gutters are attached.

Gutter Pitch:

The gentle slope of gutters that allows water to flow toward the downspouts.

Ice Dam:

A ridge of ice that forms at the roof edge, preventing melting snow from draining properly, which can cause leaks.

Expansion Crack:

Small cracks caused by natural movement of materials due to temperature changes.



Closing Message:

Congratulations on taking control of your home's health.

With **HomeGuard™**, you've created a simple, repeatable system that helps prevent costly repairs, builds long-term property value, and gives you peace of mind. Remember: maintenance is not about perfection — it's about small, consistent actions over time.

Keep using your *Monthly Tracker*, *Quick Fix Log*, *Contractor Call Sheet*, and *Annual Snapshot* to stay ahead. And always consult trusted professionals when needed.

From all of us at AB Enterprise LLC —

Let's keep your home safe, one smart step at a time.



HomeGuard™

FREEBIES



HomeGuard™ Seasonal Calendar Checklist

◆ Spring:

- Inspect roof for winter damage.
- Clean gutters.
- Check grading & drainage.
- Inspect siding for cracks.
- Service HVAC.

◆ Summer:

- Check attic ventilation.
- Inspect for pest activity.
- Pressure wash exterior (carefully).
- Inspect deck & railings.
- Trim tree branches.

◆ Fall:

- Clean gutters again.
- Check flashing and roof valleys.
- Inspect windows/doors for drafts.
- Test sump pump (if applicable).
- Seal gaps around siding/caulking.

◆ Winter:

- Monitor ice dams.
- Watch for snow load issues.
- Keep vents clear.
- Check for moisture buildup indoors.
- Prepare emergency supplies.

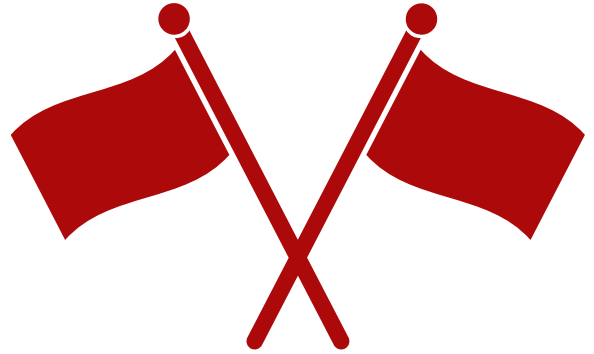




HomeGuard™ Contractor Red Flag Checklist

◆ Pre-Contract Red Flags:

- Won't provide written estimate.
- No proof of license or insurance.
- Demands full payment upfront.
- Vague on project timeline.
- High-pressure sales tactics.



◆ During Work:

- Unmarked vehicles.
- No business address or office.
- Avoids permits or inspections.
- Constant change orders without written approval.
- Workers appear untrained or unsupervised.

◆ Post-Work:

- Won't provide warranties.
- Avoids punch list or final walk-through.
- Disappears after payment.

Final Thoughts

Choosing the right contractor is one of the most important parts of protecting your home investment. Trust your instincts, ask clear questions, and never feel pressured to make rushed decisions. A reputable contractor will welcome your diligence, provide clear answers, and stand behind their work. When in doubt — pause, review, and protect your home first.



Frequently Asked Questions

Answers to help you stay confident and on track.

Q: How long does a monthly check actually take?

About 15–20 minutes once you've done it twice. The first one may take 30 — you're learning your home's baseline.

Q: What if I miss a month?

Just pick up where you left off. One missed month won't undo your progress; the habit matters more than perfection.

Q: Do I need any tools?

No. Your eyes, your hands, your phone camera, and the templates in this guide are enough. Anything that needs a ladder or more than a screwdriver is a candidate for Step 5: Flag for a Pro.

Q: I found something — how do I know if it's urgent?

Use the condition rating. Green: note it. Yellow: photograph it and re-check next month. Red — active leaks, soft or rotted wood, cracks that grow, anything electrical — call a pro now.

Q: Should I do checks in bad weather?

Walk the perimeter after major storms (safely), but do your full monthly check in dry conditions when surfaces are visible.

Q: Will this really help with insurance?

Dated notes and photos demonstrate active maintenance. They can support a claim and help show damage was sudden, not neglect. Coverage decisions always rest with the insurer.

Q: When should I upgrade to HomeGuard™ Pro?

When you want reminders, digital tracking, and direct access to vetted professionals instead of paper templates.



Milestones & Wins

Celebrate progress + track long-term impact.

Small habits deserve recognition. Check these off as you reach them:

- ☐ **First Walk Done** — completed your first monthly observation
- ☐ **3-Month Streak** — three checks in a row; you officially have a habit
- ☐ **First Quick Fix** — caught and fixed something small before it grew
- ☐ **Fully Documented** — one complete season logged in your Monthly Tracker
- ☐ **Smart Call** — flagged an issue and got a professional's opinion early
- ☐ **One Full Year** — 12 months of checks and your first Annual Snapshot

Track your impact:

Issues caught early this year: _____

Estimated repair costs avoided: \$ _____

Months of consistent checks: _____

Every box you check is money kept in your pocket and stress that never happened. Keep going.

AB HOME SOLUTIONS HOMEGUARD

WRITING CREDIT

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Monthly Observation Tracker

Stay one step ahead with your monthly home checkup.

Date of Inspection: _____

Areas Inspected:

- | | | |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ Roof | ☐ Siding | ☐ Yard |
| ☐ Gutters | ☐ Windows | ☐ Driveway |
| | | ☐ Other: _____ |

Noticed Concerns:

Condition Rating:

 Green — All Good  Yellow — Monitor  Red — Action Needed

Notes / Photos Taken? ☐ Yes ☐ No



Next Review Reminder Date: _____

Quick Fix Log

***Track small repairs to protect your home
and keep full maintenance history.***

Date of Repair: _____

Type of Repair: Check Mark ☒ ☐ DIY ☐ Pro Fix

Materials Used (optional):

Cost (if any): \$ _____ Time Spent (hours): _____

Notes on the Repair / Pro advice regarding the repair:

☐

Next Review Reminder Date: _____

Contractor Call Sheet

Collect and compare contractor information with confidence

Section 1: Contractor Information

- Company Name: _____
- Technician Name: _____
- Phone Number: _____
- License # / Certification: _____
- Insurance Verified: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Section 2: Service Details

Date of Visit: _____

Work Requested / Scope Discussed:

Section 3: Estimate Information

- Estimate Provided? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐
- Quoted Price: \$ _____
- Payment Terms: _____
- Warranty Offered: _____

Section 4: Contractor Evaluation

First Impressions / Notes:



Annual Snapshot Summary

Your year-end home health report.

Year: _____

Number of Monthly Observations Completed: _____

Number of Repairs Performed (Quick Fixes + Pro Repairs): _____

Total Maintenance Spend This Year: \$_____

Major Repairs Summary:

Preventative Work Completed

Next Year's Priorities / To-Do List:

